

The Architecture of *Grace*

BOOK FIVE · THE THRESHOLD *Autism-Adapted Edition*

VISUAL ANCHOR CHARTS · TEACHER SUPPLEMENT
Grades 11–12 · Late High School

Designed for autistic students with lower support needs
(formerly described as Level 1 / requiring support)

Twenty-eight printable anchor charts · One per page
The threshold year. Transition planning, identity consolidation, and the work of leaving.

Original curriculum: James Anthony Ramsden, Founder

EDITORIAL NOTE

Before You Begin Book 5

The threshold year — the most clinically delicate book in the curriculum

Book 5 is the curriculum's threshold. Your students are 17 and 18. Many will turn 18 inside your classroom this year. They are crossing — out of the school system, out of the IEP, out of their parents' legal authority. Some are crossing into college, into work, into independent living. Many are not. The post-IEP cliff is real. The disability-services landscape after high school is unrecognizable to anyone used to public school. Your students have, in most cases, been told nothing about this.

Book 5 also contains the curriculum's heaviest clinical territory:

- Transcendent forgiveness — including forgiving people who never apologized, who have died, who never will.
- The cost of long-held bitterness — and the specific health, relational, and mortality data.
- Releasing the childhood backpack — the version of themselves they have outgrown, sometimes including diagnoses delivered without care.
- Graduation of the Heart — the closing artifact of the entire K-12 arc. The HIGHEST-risk lesson in the curriculum.

Why this book is the highest clinical risk

Autistic adolescent suicide risk does not end at graduation. Multiple studies suggest the period 6-18 months AFTER graduation may be when risk peaks: the IEP is gone, the structure is gone, the daily presence of trusted adults is gone, the friend group has scattered. The autistic young adult who was managing — barely — inside a structured environment may struggle profoundly without it. Book 5's lessons are designed for this. They cannot prevent the risk. They CAN ensure your students leave your classroom having heard, directly and explicitly, that the risk exists, what it looks like, and where to call.

THE GRADUATION OF THE HEART LESSON

The closing lesson of the entire K-12 arc (U3L7) is the highest-risk lesson in the entire curriculum. It must be co-facilitated by a counselor. It must NOT be scheduled in the final week before graduation when student attendance and counselor availability are both unstable. It should be taught in late April or early May, when there is still time for follow-up. Crisis Resources for emerging adults are appended. Read the lesson specialist note carefully before teaching.

ON THE THRESHOLD

Three structural notes for teaching Book 5: First, the post-graduation cliff is real and your students need to be told about it BEFORE it happens, not after. Second, supported decision-making (the alternative to legal guardianship for autistic adults 18+) needs to be raised with families before the 18th birthday — not after. Third, college disability-services systems are radically different from K-12 IEP systems and require the student to self-advocate. Many of your students have never self-advocated for an accommodation in their life. This is the year to practice it.

CONTENTS

All Twenty-Eight Charts

Book 5 · The Threshold · Grades 11–12 · Lower Support

UNIT 1 COMPASS OF VALUES · THE LIFE COMPASS		
L1	The Exit Interview	
L2	Mapping Values	
L3	Values Under Fire	★ PPRA
L4	Values in the Workplace	
L5	Neuroscience of Moral Development	
L6	Moral North Star	★ PPRA
L7	Compass of Integrity	
UNIT 2 ADULT REPAIR MANUAL · SELF-COMPASSION		
L1	The Living Amend	★ PPRA
L2	Forgiving the Younger Self	★ PPRA
L3	Mental Health Literacy for Adults	CRISIS RESOURCES
L4	The Sustainable Soul	★ PPRA
L5	Forgiveness Fatigue	
L6	Inheritance of Grace	★ PPRA
L7	Final Backpack Audit	★★ HIGHEST RISK
UNIT 3 TRANSCENDENT FORGIVENESS · FOR ADULTS		
L1	Forgiveness as Leadership	
L2	Releasing the Childhood Backpack	★ PPRA
L3	Complex Reconciliation	★ PPRA
L4	Global Empathy	★ PPRA
L5	The Cost of Bitterness	★★ HIGHEST RISK
L6	Forgiveness as Legacy	
L7	Graduation of the Heart	★★★ CULMINATING
UNIT 4 ORCHARD LEGACY · GRACE CULTURE		
L1	Systemic Grace	
L2	Radical Generosity	
L3	Counseling vs. Canceling	★ PPRA
L4	Charitable Interpretation at Scale	★ PPRA
L5	The Mentor Path	

L6	Graduation Charter	PERMANENT
L7	Final Celebration	PERMANENT

The Exit Interview

Twelve years in the system. The questions only YOU can answer.

WHAT THE SYSTEM TAUGHT ME	WHAT I AM TAKING WITH ME
What I had to do to get good grades. <i>What I had to perform to be considered “well-behaved.”</i> <i>What I had to hide to be considered “normal.”</i> <i>What I learned to apologize for that I should not have apologized for.</i>	What I actually believe — not what I was told to believe. <i>What I am good at — that the system never measured.</i> <i>The friendships that survived this place.</i> <i>The version of me that I am no longer willing to lose.</i>

Some of what school taught me, I will keep. Some I will leave at the door on the way out.

SPECIALIST NOTE • FOR THE TEACHER

The opening chart of Book 5. For autistic students, the ‘what I had to perform to be considered well-behaved’ line is load-bearing. Many will recognize, in this exit-interview frame, that twelve years of behavioral expectations have shaped them in ways they did not consent to. Hold the room. Some students will need to sit with this for a week before they can speak. The lesson is not about anger at the system — it is about taking inventory of what they choose to carry forward. The work is theirs.

POST Day 1 of Book 5.	KEEP All year — return at each unit boundary.
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Mapping Values

Not what the brochure says. What you would defend at cost.

INHERITED Values from family. Some I keep — some I am examining.	BORROWED Values I tried on from a friend, a teacher, a community.
FORGED Values built from things I have lived through. Hard-won.	EMERGING Values I am only starting to understand. Not yet fixed.

My values are a working draft. The draft has my name on it.

SPECIALIST NOTE • FOR THE TEACHER

The four-quadrant frame helps students distinguish what they actually hold from what they have been told to hold. For autistic students, this distinction may matter more than for any other population: many have spent years performing a values set that was assigned rather than chosen. The FORGED quadrant often contains the deepest material — values built from experiences others did not have. Honor what is written there.

POST Before class.	KEEP Carried through Unit 1.
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